

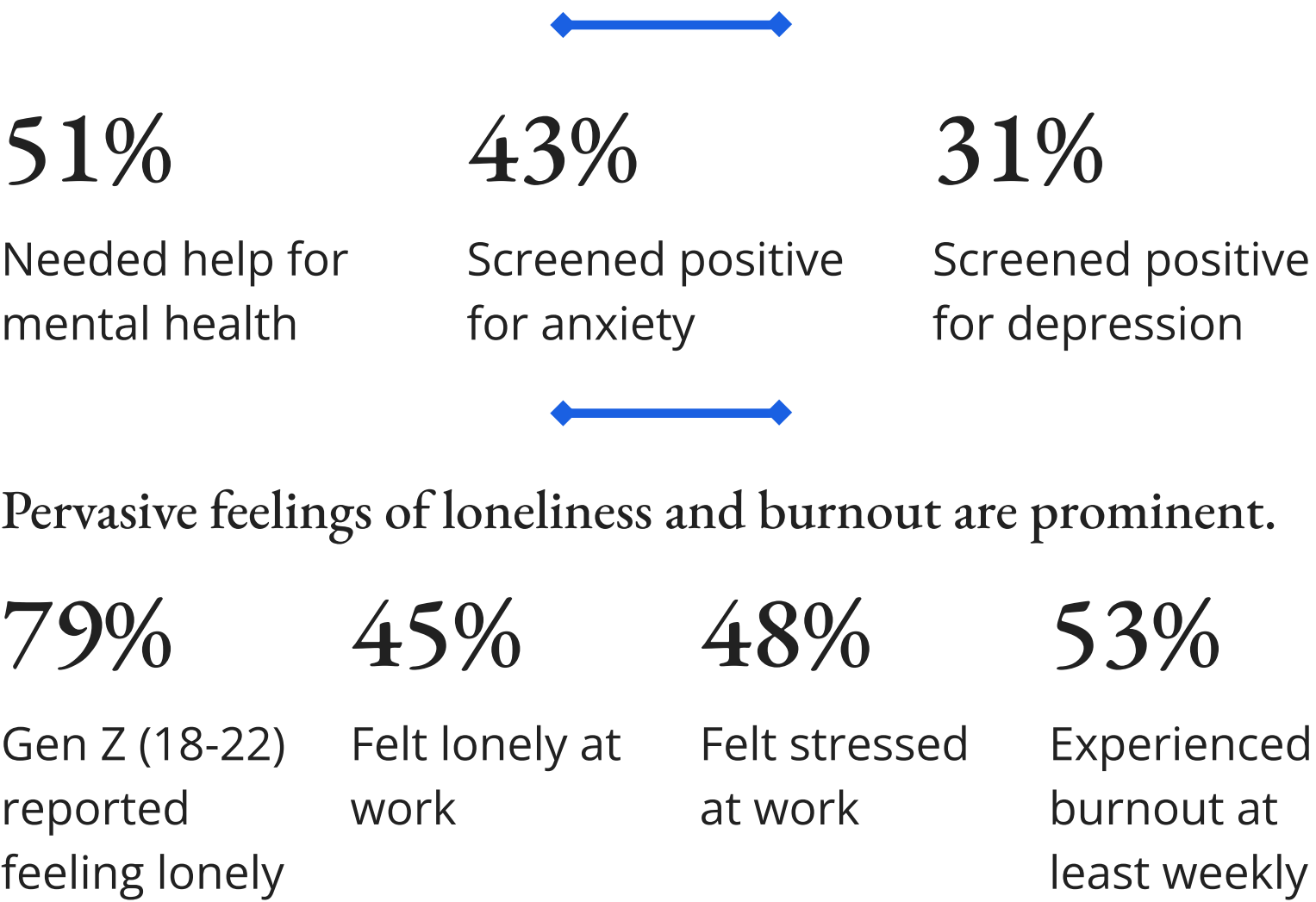
Overview

What’s the problem?

Millions of young professionals experience persistent feelings of anxiety, burnout, loneliness, and low self-worth — not always severe enough to seek therapy, but serious enough to affect daily focus, relationships, and motivation.

How do we know its a real problem [@](#)

The data overwhelmingly indicates a high incidence of mental health concerns within this group including anxiety, depression, loneliness, and burnout, often exacerbated by digital influences and workplace dynamics.



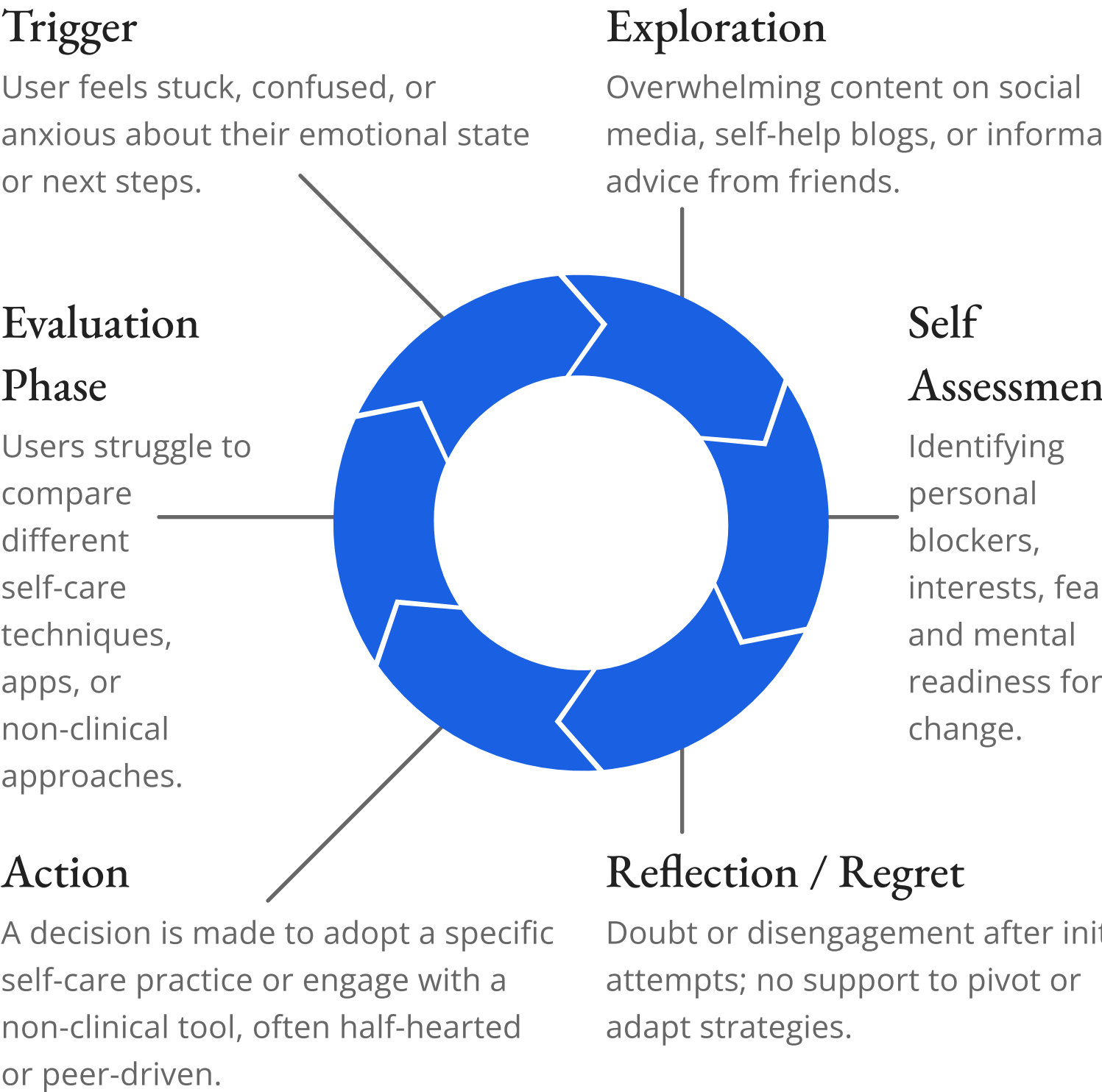
Goal

To build an MVP for a product that helps **young professionals** recognize, regulate, and reflect on their mental health before it reaches a crisis point.

Who are these ‘young professionals’?

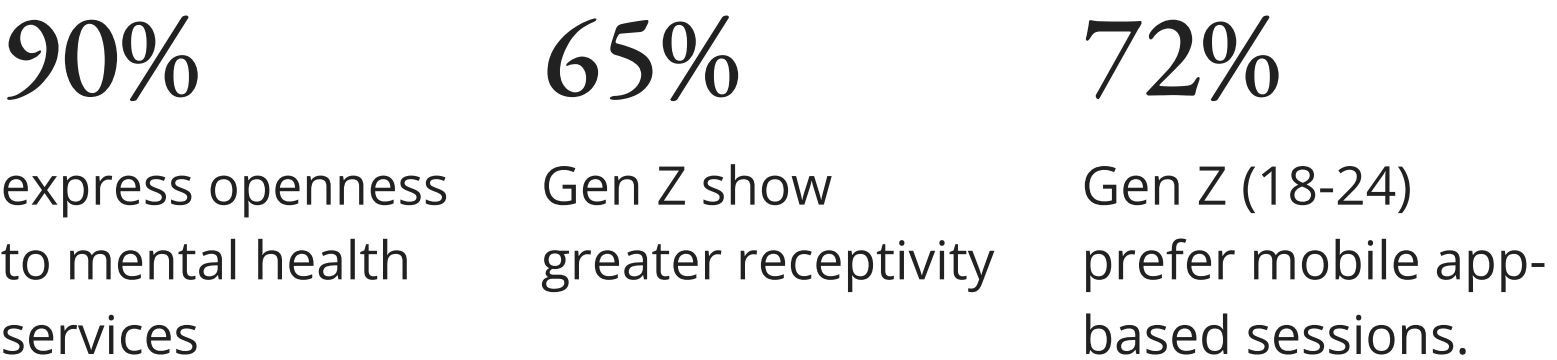
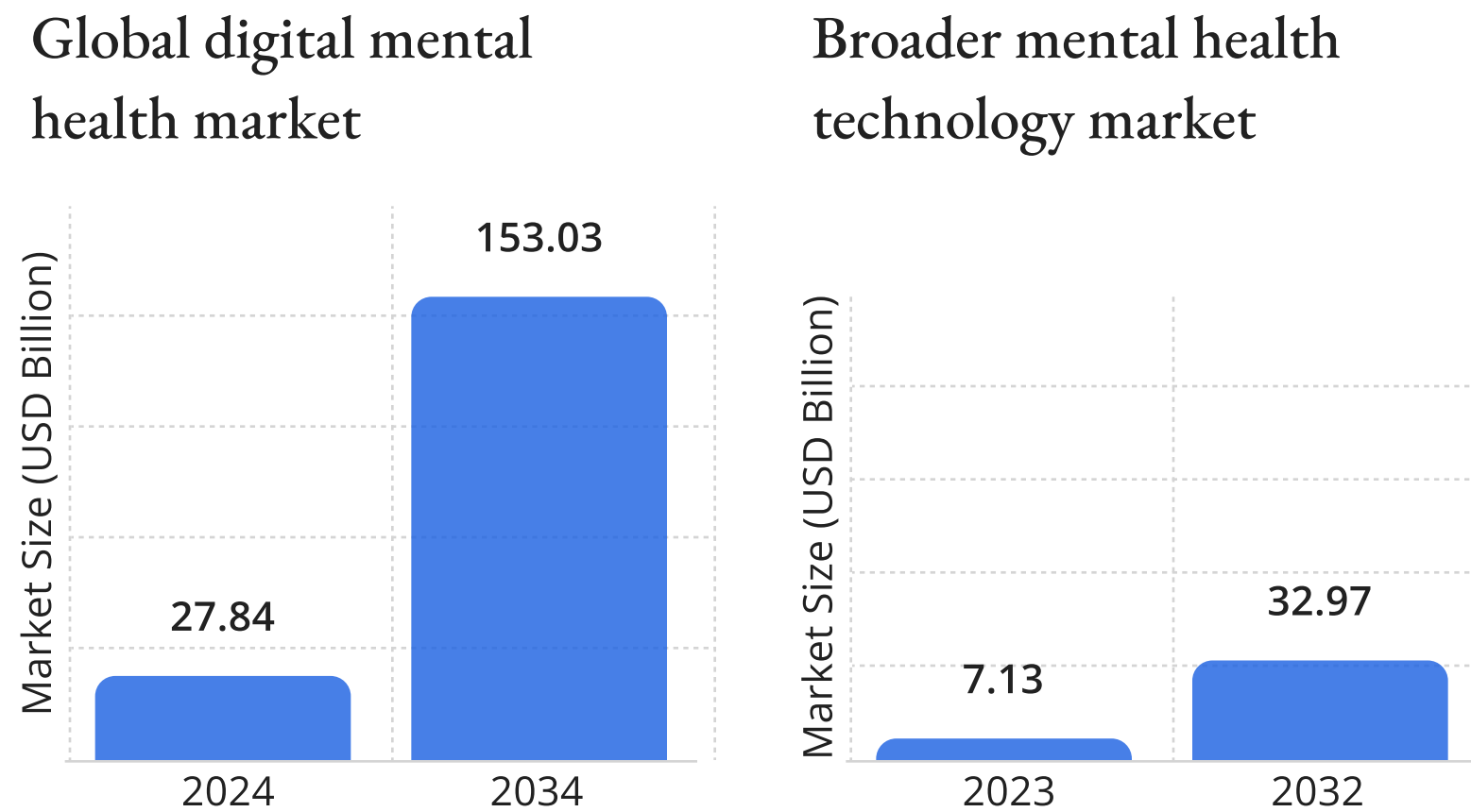
These demographic, primarily encompasses Millennials and Gen Z, generally aged 22 - 35 years old who are employed in professional or white-collar occupations, typically in early to mid-career stages.

Mental Well-being Lifecycle



Market Overview and Growth

The global digital mental health market is experiencing robust growth, reflecting a burgeoning demand for accessible and innovative mental wellness tools.



Actors involved in the system

1. Young Professionals
2. Businesses
3. App Developers
4. Wearable Data Providers

Competitive analysis and User Segmentation

Competitor Landscape [Detailed Documentation](#)

Barrier Category	Type of Solution	Key Features	Monetization Model
Calm	Mindfulness/ Meditation	Guided meditations, breathing, sleep stories, music, soundscapes.	Freemium (Subscription)
Wysa	AI-Powered Emotional Support	AI chatbot, CBT, guided meditations, mood tracking, self-help.	Freemium (Subscription for advanced features/coach access)
Rocky.ai	AI-Powered Coaching	Daily micro-coaching, goal tracking, personalized plans, positive psychology.	Subscription Model
Finch	Gamified Self-Care	Virtual pet, self-care journeys (breathing, journaling), goal/mood tracking, quizzes.	Freemium (In-app purchases, premium subscription)
Happify	Gamified Self-Care	Science-backed activities/games (positive psychology, CBT), personalized programs.	Freemium (Full access subscription)
HeyPeers	Peer Support Platform	Peer support groups, 1-on-1 coaching, chatrooms, trained supporters.	Freemium (Optional premium, B2B partnerships)

Chosen Segment:

Young Professionals with Mental Health Challenges who are open to utilizing non-clinical digital mental health solutions that a new non-clinical mental well-being solution can realistically acquire within its initial operational period (e.g., 3-5 years).

High Need & Receptivity

Individuals here are both struggling and predisposed to digital solutions, ensuring higher engagement.

Actionability

This segment represents our immediate, achievable target, allowing for focused strategy.

Strategic Focus

Targeting the SOM provides a clear roadmap for market penetration and sustainable growth.

Initial Hypothesis: Why Young Professionals Delay/Avoid Non-Clinical Mental Well-being Support

Awareness

Users lack understanding of non-clinical digital mental well-being solutions, especially when not in acute distress.

Distrust in Reliability

Distrust in the long-term effectiveness and consistency of digital mental well being tools, often due to prior experiences with generic advice.

Value Comparison

Perceived benefits of structured solutions may not outweigh the immediate, though often insufficient, gratification of informal coping.

Ingrained Habit

Users often stick to less effective coping habits (e.g., social media, casual conversations) even for non-urgent mental well-being needs.

Poor User Experience

A complicated or non-seamless user experience in discovering, onboarding, & consistent engagement often leads to early dropout.

Concerns about Privacy

Despite digital platforms often offering anonymity, data privacy concerns or the perceived visibility of struggles deter engagement.

Impact Calculation [@](#)

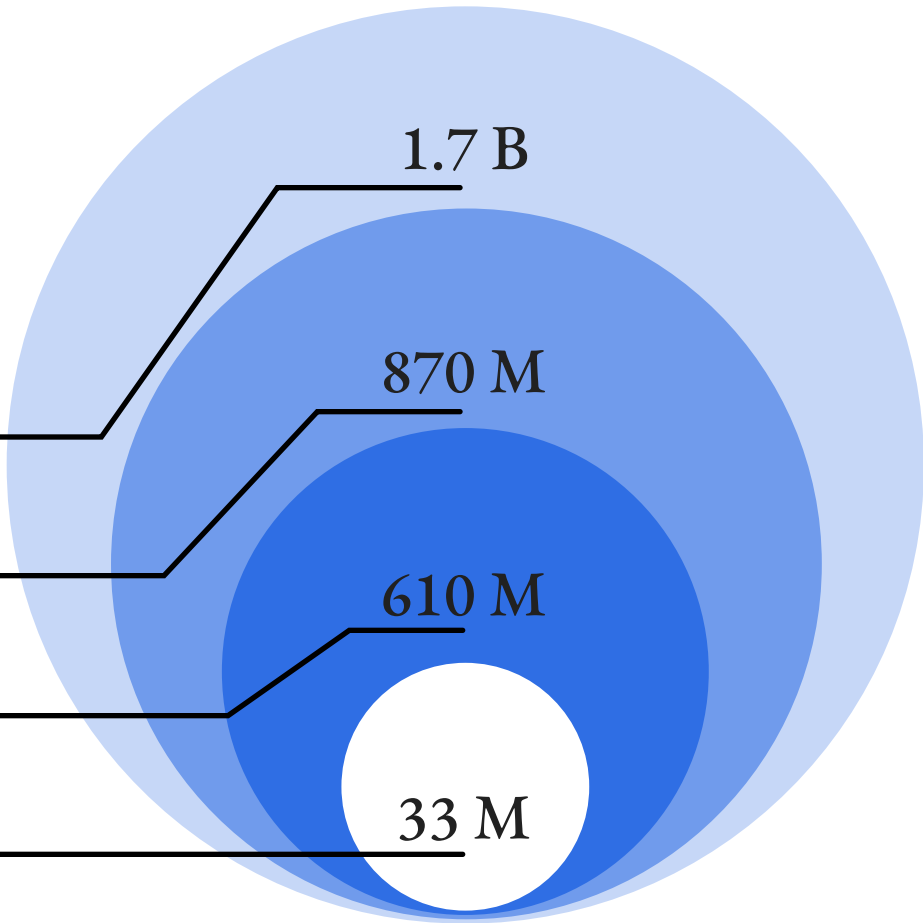
The sizing estimate for the chosen segment: ~33 Million

Total Available Market (TAM)

Total Addressable Market (TAM - Refined)

Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)

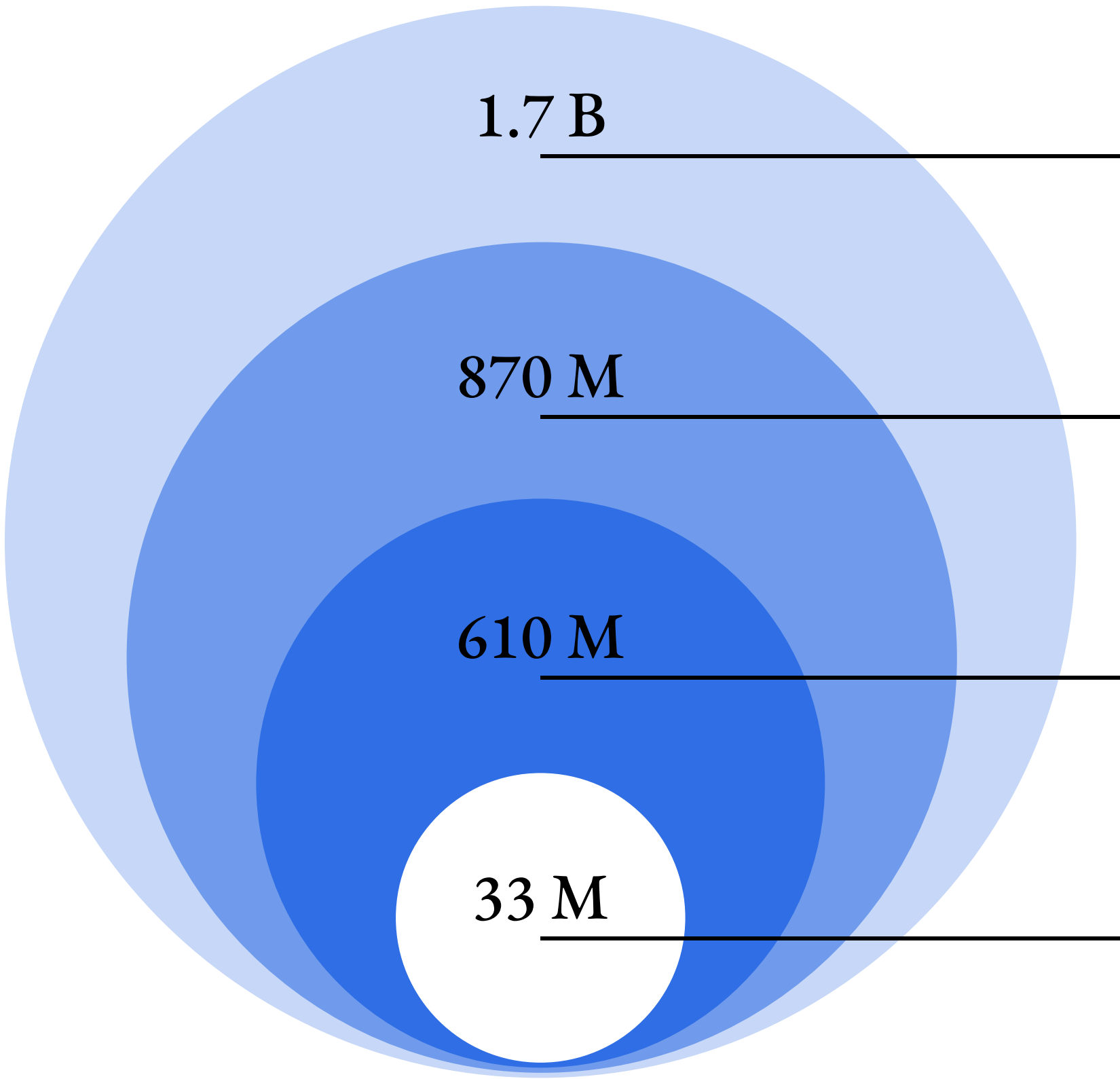
Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)



Impact Calculation

Chosen Segment:

Our primary target is the Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM): early to mid-career young professionals experiencing mental health challenges who are open to digital non-clinical solutions and are realistically acquirable within our initial operational period



Total Available Market (TAM)

The global workforce of Millennials and Gen Z in early to mid-career stages

Global labor force: ~3.5 billion.
Millennials & Gen Z: ~75% of global workforce by 2025.
Early/Mid-Career Filter: ~65% of young professionals.
Calculation: $\sim 3.5 \text{ Billion} \times 0.75 \times 0.65 = \sim 1.7 \text{ Billion}$.

Total Addressable Market (TAM - Refined)

The subset of TAM actively experiencing or recently experienced mental health challenges addressable by non-clinical solutions.

51% of young professionals report needing help for emotional/mental health.
Calculation: $1.7 \text{ Billion} \times 0.51 = \sim 870 \text{ Million}$

Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)

Early/mid-career young professionals within the refined TAM who are open to utilizing non-clinical digital mental health solutions.

70% of young professionals experiencing mental health challenges are open to non-clinical digital solutions.
Calculation: $870 \text{ Million} \times 0.70 = \sim 610 \text{ Million}$

Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)

The realistic segment of the SAM that a new non-clinical mental well-being solution can acquire within its initial operational period (e.g., 3-5 years).

Conservative initial market capture rate of ~5.4% of the SAM, considering competition and adoption curves.
Calculation: $610 \text{ Million} \times 0.054 = \sim 33 \text{ Million}$

What do the users say?

Key Takeaways & Emerging Patterns/Trends:

Despite a strong **97%** Majority **74%**
think tracking emotional well-being is important, have not used mental wellness apps,

And those who have (36%, 10 out of 35) the primary reasons for stopping include:

- 1. apps being too generic (70%)
- 2. require too much effort (60%)
- 3. Making them feel worse for missing check-ins (50%)

This indicates that the current app landscape is failing to meet user needs effectively, creating a significant barrier to widespread adoption despite a general interest in tracking well-being.

While **75%** Find tracking their emotional well-being important, Personalization is one of the top motivator for app usage. and for **49%** However, **70%** Find existing advice (from friends or online) to be generic or only somewhat relevant.

This highlights a significant unmet need for tailored, effective, and easily accessible mental wellness resources.

My Approach: Conducted a survey which had over **30 responses** and took 1:1 interviews of **6 users** from my chosen segment.

User Personas [Survey link](#) [Survey Questions](#)



Sarah Chen
Archetype: The Analytical Seeker
Age: 29
Profession: Data Scientist
Lives with: Partner

"I don't just want to feel better; I want to understand why I feel what I feel. Give me data, insights, and proven strategies, not just platitudes."

Sarah approaches mental well-being with a logical, evidence-based mindset and seeks to understand the underlying patterns of her emotions and prefers quantifiable progress. She's drawn to scientific, research-backed strategies that offer clear insights and systematic improvement.

Needs/Motivations

- 1. Understand root causes and emotional patterns.
- 2. Measurable progress and data-driven insights.
- 3. Evidence-based techniques and research-backed strategies.
- 4. Systematic improvement for resilience.

Painpoints

- 1. Frustrated by generic advice lacking principles/results.
- 2. Apps feel "fluffy" or unscientific, lacking depth.
- 3. Difficulty tracking well-being without clear metrics.
- 4. Feels like guessing, lacks structured plan.



Pratik Joshi
Archetype: The Overwhelmed Achiever
Age: 26
Profession: Equity Analyst
Lives with: Roommates

"The constant pressure of my career is draining me. I need a reset button that doesn't add to my endless to-do list."

Pratik is a driven professional in a demanding corporate role. He frequently feels overwhelmed and anxious, impacting his work and life. Battling burnout and relentless pressure, he seeks efficient and effective digital wellness tools that don't feel like another generic task.

Needs/Motivations

- 1. Quick, effective stress and anxiety management.
- 2. Visible progress and feeling calmer/more focused.
- 3. Absolute privacy and confidentiality.
- 4. Personalized, tailored advice for unique pressures.

Painpoints

- 1. "I'm constantly in burnout and exhaustion."
- 2. Emotional state harms work productivity.
- 3. Mental wellness apps feel like a chore.
- 4. Generic advice from friends/online.

The user research validates our initial hypotheses; the major barriers to MH supports are:

Value Comparison

Many prefer informal, often generic, advice over structured digital solutions, even if less effective.

Distrust in Reliability

Users stop apps due to generic content and no perceived improvement, fueling skepticism.

Concerns about Privacy:

Privacy is a key motivator for app usage, as shown by Pratik's needs.

Poor User Experience

Apps are generic, effort-intensive, and induce guilt, leading to user abandonment.

Framing of the problem

What is the true problem?

Ineffective & Unengaging Current Solutions	Frequent, Impactful Emotional Distress	Privacy Concerns Deter Engagement	Barrier to Articulation & Relevant Help
Existing non-clinical digital mental well-being tools are often generic, demand high effort, and fail to demonstrate tangible improvement, leading to user distrust	Young professionals face high emotional distress that significantly impacts their work, relationships, and overall enjoyment of life.	Despite the potential for digital anonymity, strong user concerns about data privacy and the perceived visibility of their struggles deter engagement with wellness solutions	A significant struggle to clearly explain feelings hinders effective coping and the ability to receive truly personalized and relevant support

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

For the target customers - Improved emotional well-being and reduced distress. - Enhanced work productivity and personal relationships. - Access to personalized, effective, and low-effort coping mechanisms. - Increased self-awareness and ability to articulate emotions. - Empowerment through consistent, visible progress tracking.	For the business - Significant untapped market opportunity (65.52% haven't used apps). - High potential for user acquisition and long-term retention by directly addressing core pain points. - Establishment as a leader in personalized, effective non-clinical digital mental wellness. - Positive social impact by improving the well-being of a critical, high-potential demographic.
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Who are the customers facing this problem?

Young Professionals with Mental Health Challenges who are open to utilizing non-clinical digital mental health solutions that a new non-clinical mental well-being solution can realistically acquire within its initial operational period (e.g., 3-5 years).

How do we know it is a real problem?

User Research
Survey shows high distrust (80%), Communication Struggle (83%), Low App Adoption (66%) and Poor App Experience
Hypothesis Validation
Confirmed Poor User Experience, Distrust in Reliability, Value Comparison (informal vs. structured coping), and Concerns about Privacy as significant barriers, reflecting user pain points.

Why should we solve this problem now?

Urgent & Widespread Need	Ineffective Current Solutions
A large majority of young professionals are actively struggling with frequent emotional distress, impacting multiple life areas.	Existing digital and informal coping mechanisms are failing to provide adequate or sustainable support, as evidenced by low adoption and high abandonment rates.
Clear Market Opportunity	Gap in Personalized Support
There is a strong, unmet demand for personalized, easy-to-use, effective, and private digital solutions that can demonstrate tangible progress.	Addressing these barriers now offers a unique opportunity to create a meaningful impact on individual well-being and capture a significant market share in the growing digital mental health space.

Feature Prioritization for “Unburden”

What does the MVP solve and what’s the scope?

"Unburden" provides a structured, personalized, emotionally safe platform to help young professionals recognize, regulate, and reflect on their mental health before it escalates to a crisis point. Our MVP aims to fill the critical gap left by generic advice and inaccessible professional help, prioritizing emotional safety over diagnosis, consistency over intensity, and reflection over performance. The tool enables proactive self-management and fosters long-term resilience and well-being.

Core outcomes to Be driving the MVP

Trusted Personalization

Instead of generic advice, the tool aligns to the user's unique emotional loops and physiological data, boosting trust and confidence.

Higher Clarity

Users reach deeper self-understanding by identifying emotional patterns and triggers, moving beyond vague confusion.

Stronger Consistency

Users return regularly to practice micro-interventions and engage in reflection, building sustainable habits.

Feature Overview

Self-Discovery Assessment

Interactive AI-guided assessment to identify unique "emotional loops" non-judgmentally.

Daily Resilience Practice

Personalized daily micro-interventions with streaks for consistency.

Wearable Data Insights

Integrates wearable data (sleep, activity, HRV) for emotional well-being insights.

Guided Reflection

Curated content and AI-guided prompts for deep self-inquiry.

Wellness Events Hub

Curated marketplace for mental health events; B2C & B2B booking.

Feature Prioritization using

Feature	Category	MoSCoW	Why It Matters
Self-Discovery Assessment	Core MVP	Must-Have	Helps users clarify root causes of distress by identifying specific emotional/behavioral loops, ensuring emotional safety and reflection.
Daily Resilience Practice	Core MVP	Must-Have	Drives consistent engagement by offering personalized, manageable daily activities, promoting consistency over intensity.
Wearable Data Insights	Core MVP	Should-Have	Provides objective, non-judgmental insights into physiological patterns, enhancing personalization and fostering deeper reflection beyond self-report.
Guided Reflection	MVP Diff.	Should-Have	Directly breaks "Advice Overload Without Actions" by fostering deeper self-inquiry and tailored reflection.
HeyPeers	Future Consideratn	Could-Have	Expands regulation and reflection by connecting users with external, structured experiences, facilitating real-world connections.

Competitive Differentiation

Most tools offer advice or mentorship but leave users confused on what to choose. We focus on emotional safety, consistent engagement, and deep reflection, providing structured, personalized clarity. This shift builds trust, reduces directionless churn, and creates habit loops over time.

Core Product Hypothesis & Value Proposition

Atomic Unit

A personalized micro intervention that guides users to recognize, regulate, & reflect on their mental well-being based on their real patterns, not generic advice.

Riskiest Hypothesis

Users reach deeper self-understanding by identifying emotional patterns and triggers, moving beyond vague confusion.

Key Value Proposition

Users return regularly to practice micro-interventions and engage in reflection, building sustainable habits.

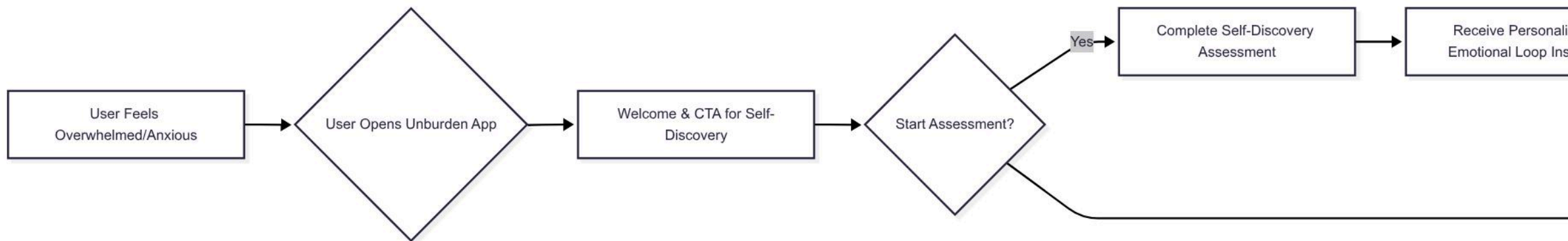
“Unburden” Core User Flow Journey - From Self-Discovery to Daily Practice

User Scenario

Pratik, a young professional, feels a vague sense of anxiety and overwhelm but isn't sure why or how to address it. He opens Unburden for the first time.

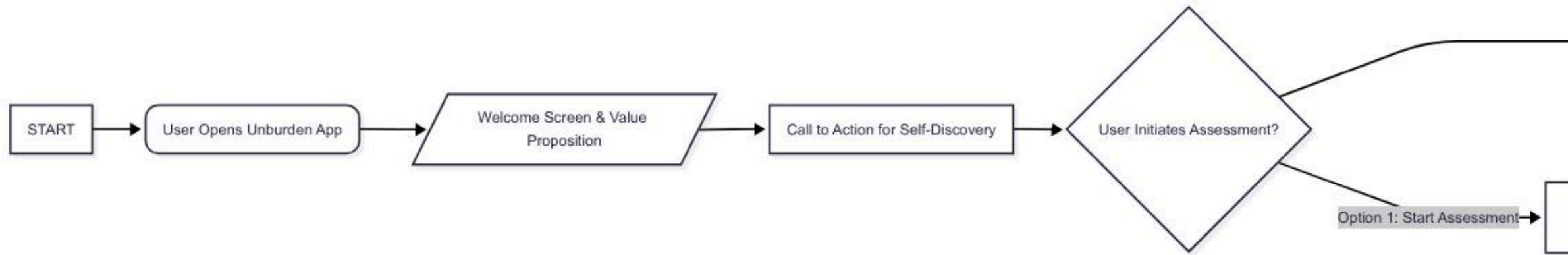
Taskflow diagram [View detailed user flow diagram](#)

This user flow illustrates a simple, intuitive journey for a new user engaging with Unburden's core "Must-Have" features: the Self-Discovery Assessment and the Daily Resilience Practice. The goal is to guide the user from initial self-awareness to consistent, personalized action.



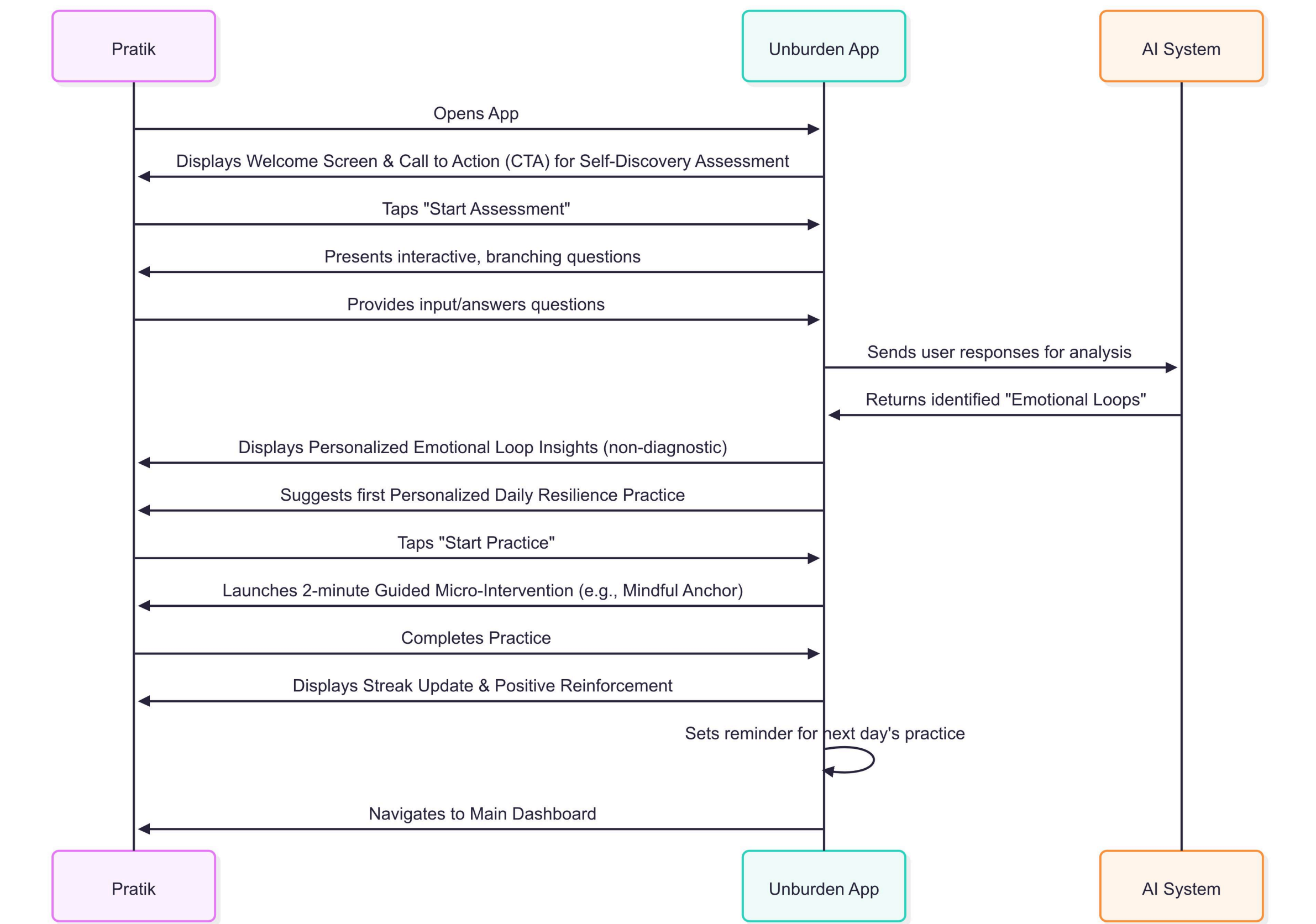
Userflow diagram [View detailed user flow diagram](#)

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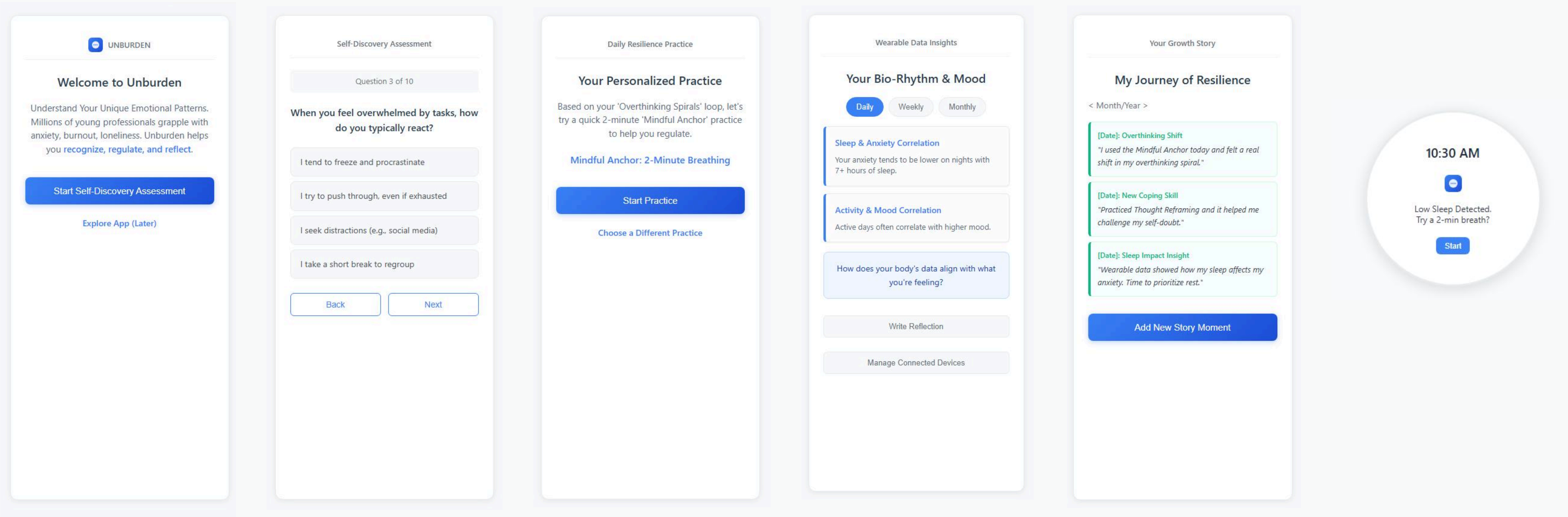


Sequence diagram [View detailed sequence diagram](#)

This sequence diagram visually represents the interaction between the User (Pratik), the Unburden App, and the AI System for the core user flow involving the Self-Discovery Assessment and Daily Resilience Practice.



“Unburden” Core User Flow Wireframes



Greet the user, introduce Unburden's value, and prompt them to begin their self-discovery journey.

Engage the user in the interactive assessment process, collecting insights into their emotional patterns.

Introduce the personalized daily practice, linking it directly to the user's identified emotional loops.

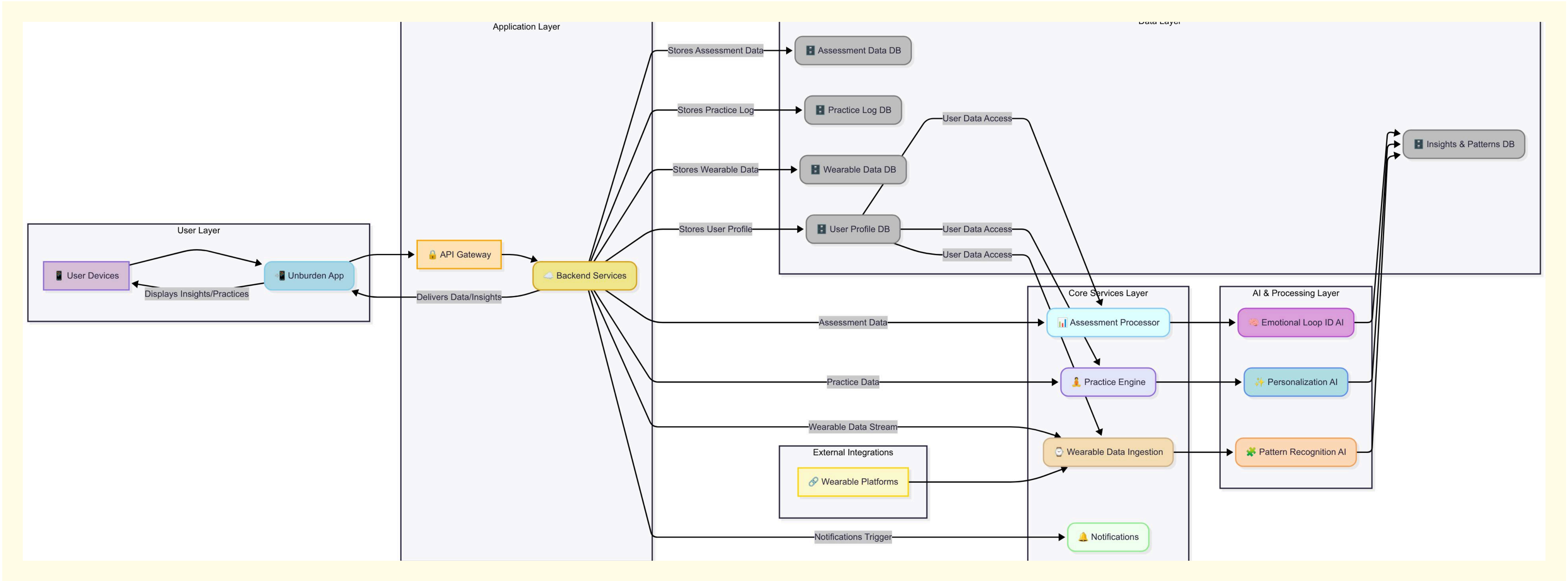
Display objective physiological data from wearables and correlate it with self-reported emotional states, fostering reflection without diagnosis.

Provide a visual and narrative timeline of the user's emotional journey, emphasizing reflection and long-term growth.

Provide quick, glanceable insights from wearable data and deliver timely, gentle nudges for daily resilience practices, promoting consistency and proactive regulation.

Success Metrics Of The MVP & the System Architecture

System Architecture & Data Flows



Monetization - Distribution - Risk & Mitigation Strategy

Monetization Plan Goal

To build a sustainable and scalable business model that balances accessibility for individual users with value for B2B partners, ensuring long-term profitability and broad impact.

Freemium Model With Smart Unlocks (B2C)

Attracts early-career professionals hesitant to pay upfront, converting them as they experience tangible well-being shifts.

Plan: Core features (e.g., basic Self-Discovery Assessment, limited Daily Resilience Practice) are free. Premium subscription unlocks deeper insights, advanced personalization, and comprehensive features.

Outcome: Drives organic user acquisition and conversion through demonstrated value.

B2B Partnerships (B2B - B2C Model)

Why: Taps into growing corporate investment in employee well-being with a scalable, non-clinical solution.

Wellness Events Hub (B2B2C): Partner with event organizers (B2B) for event listings, taking a commission on user bookings (Pay-per-Session). Companies can also sponsor employee event access.

Outcome: Drives non-linear growth via high-trust partners and diversifies revenue.

Distribution

Multi-Channel Strategy for Broad Reach & Trust

Peer-Led Growth:

Leverages social proof and emotional virality, reducing acquisition costs.

Encourage users to share anonymized "Personal Growth Stories" or invite friends, highlighting "Before vs After" insights.

Corporate Wellness Programs

Direct access to large user bases through established employer relationships.

Engage in direct partnerships with companies, offering pilot programs and white-labeled solutions to demonstrate ROI in employee well-being.

Content Marketing

Establishes "Unburden" as an expert and trusted resource in mental well-being.

Publish valuable content (articles, webinars) on young professional mental health to showcase platform effectiveness.

Risk & Mitigation Strategy

Feature	Risk	Mitigation
Self-Discovery Assessment	User reluctance to be vulnerable; AI misinterpretation/ simplification; feeling "diagnosed."	Robust privacy/security; empathetic, non-judgmental language; continuous AI fine-tuning with feedback; clear non-diagnostic disclaimers
Daily Resilience Practice	Lack of perceived relevance/ effectiveness; streak fatigue; inconsistency in user engagement.	Continuous A/B testing of micro-interventions; flexible streak system; focus on progress, not perfection; varied content; gentle reminders.
Wearable Data Insights	Data privacy concerns; inaccurate/ misleading insights; technical integration complexity.	Industry-leading security & transparent privacy policy; frame insights as correlations, not diagnoses; start with major platforms; robust error handling.
Monetization (Freemium)	Low conversion from free to paid users.	Clearly differentiate free vs. premium value; offer compelling premium features (e.g., advanced insights, deeper personalization); A/B test pricing tiers and trial periods.
Distribution (Peer-Led Growth)	Limited viral loop if users are hesitant to share personal well-being journeys.	Emphasize anonymity and control over shared content; focus on sharing "growth milestones" rather than raw data; provide engaging, shareable formats.
B2B Sales Resistance	Companies may prefer established providers or clinical tools; long sales cycles.	Focus on "Unburden's" non-clinical, proactive approach as a differentiator; highlight ROI in employee retention/ productivity; offer pilot programs and case studies.
Wellness Events Hub (B2B2C)	Quality control of external events; technical booking/payment complexity; low adoption by organizers or users.	Strict vetting for organizers; align with "Unburden" principles; use established APIs for booking/payment; competitive commissions/reach for organizers.